HANDBOOK

WB Group ERP

Everything the system does, written for somebody who has never used an ERP before. No accounting background assumed.

COMPANIES COVERED	MODULES COVERED	JURISDICTION
WBE · WBTS · VTS · WBM	Finance · HR · Administration	United Arab Emirates

START HERE

What this system is

An ERP is one place where the whole business is written down, instead of a folder of spreadsheets that nobody else can open. When a storekeeper records hours on site, the accountant sees the cost on that job, the payroll clerk sees it on the payslip, and the manager sees whether the job is still inside its budget. Nobody re-types anything, and there is only ever one version of the truth.

This system is built for a UAE engineering and technical-services group. That shapes almost every screen: it knows about the FTA and VAT 201, about MOHRE and the WPS file your bank wants, about retention held back on a certificate, about the summer midday break, and about gratuity at the end of service. You will not find generic software wording where a UAE term belongs.

Four companies, one system

The group runs four legal companies, and each keeps its own books, its own employees and its own tax registration. You switch between them with the dropdown at the top-left of every screen. Nothing crosses between them by accident — a voucher posted in WBE can never touch WBTS.

CODE	COMPANY
WBE	WB Engineering
WBTS	WB Technical Services
VTS	Voice Technical Services
WBM	WB Maintenance

IF A SCREEN LOOKS EMPTY

Check the company switcher first. You are probably looking at a company that has no records of that kind yet, rather than at a fault.

Signing in

Open the address your administrator gave you, and enter your email and password. A few things behave deliberately:

- After three wrong passwords the account locks itself for fifteen minutes, and every administrator is notified. This is not a punishment — it is what stops somebody guessing their way in.
- If an administrator has just reset your password, you are asked to choose your own before you can go any further. Nobody else should know your password, including them.
- Signing in, signing out, and every failed attempt are written into the audit trail with the time and the address you came from.

NEVER SHARE A LOGIN

Everything anybody does is recorded against the name they signed in with. Two people on one login means the record is wrong, and there is no way to untangle it afterwards.

Changing your own password

Open the account menu at the top-right, then *My Account & Password*. Changing it signs you out of every other device automatically — which is exactly what you want if you think somebody else has been using it.

Finding your way around

Three things are on every screen, always in the same place.

> **The left menu**
> `Down the left-hand side`
>
> Everything you are allowed to open, grouped by area. Click a group heading to collapse it. The arrow at the top shrinks the whole menu to icons when you want more room.
>
> If a menu item you expected is not there, you have not lost it — your role does not include it. See Users and access.

> **The company switcher**
> `Top-left, above the page`
>
> Changes which company's records you are looking at. It follows you as you move between screens, so you will not find yourself reading the wrong company's figures after a few clicks.

> **The tabs across the top**
> `Inside Finance and inside HR`
>
> Finance and HR each hold a lot of screens, so the tabs come in two levels. The top row is the *area* — Entry, Registers, Job Costing, Reports, Tax, Setup. When the area you opened has more than one screen in it, a smaller second row appears underneath listing them.
>
> At the far right of that row, *All reports* opens the full list of reports across the whole system.

> **THE QUICKEST WAY TO LEARN A SCREEN**
>
> Click the **?** in the top bar. It shows help for the exact page you are looking at, in the same plain English as this handbook.

Small things worth knowing

- **Day and night mode.** The toggle in the top bar. Your choice is remembered on that device.
- **Dates are British format** throughout — `31/12/2026` is the last day of December, never the twelfth of the month.
- **Printing.** Any report prints properly: the menus and buttons drop away and the company letterhead appears at the top.
- **Getting data out.** Most screens have an *Export* button that gives you a spreadsheet file.

What you will actually use

Almost nobody uses the whole system. Find your job below and read those sections first; the rest will still be there when you need it.

IF YOU ARE THE...	YOU WILL LIVE IN
Site timekeeper	Attendance & Muster. That is all — and the hours you record become the cost on every job.
HR officer	Employees, Onboarding, Leave, Certifications, Compliance & Expiry.
Accountant	Invoices, Day Book, Ledgers, Outstanding, Cheques, VAT.
Finance controller	The above, plus Reports, Cash Flow, Corporate Tax and Finance Settings.

Project manager	Job Costing, Work in Progress, Manhours, Job Assignments.
Operations manager	The Dashboard and the Reports centre, mostly.

SETTING UP

The first week, in order

This is the one genuinely sequential part of the system: each step needs the one before it. Work down the list and nothing will refuse you halfway through.

1. **Complete each company's details**

   Companies → the pencil icon. Fill in the **VAT registration number (TRN)**, and the address split into line, city and emirate. No invoice can be issued without the TRN — a tax invoice is not valid without it — and the emirate travels as its own field on an electronic invoice.

2. **Check the chart of accounts**

   Finance → Overview. A standard UAE contracting chart is already there. Mark every bank and petty cash account with *Control account → Cash or bank*: that is what the Cash Flow Forecast starts from, and a missed one makes the forecast start short.

3. **Enter opening balances**

   If you are moving from another system, put each account's closing balance in as its opening balance, and set the date those balances are stated as at. Do this before posting anything new.

4. **Add customers and suppliers**

   Finance → Registers → Parties. Record the TRN and the payment terms in days — the terms decide every due date the system calculates afterwards, so you never type one.

5. **Set the finance settings**

   Finance → Setup. The VAT rate, the corporate tax band, when a cheque goes stale, and **payday** — the day of the month wages are paid, which the cash flow forecast turns on.

6. **Write down your HR policy**

   HR → HR Policy. Leave, probation, notice, overtime rates, sick pay, gratuity, the air ticket. The system will not let you set anything below what UAE law requires, and it tells you which article says so.

7. **Add your people**

   HR → People → Employees. Then their documents — visa, Emirates ID, MOL Person ID, passport — with the expiry dates, so the Compliance report can warn you before anything lapses.

8. **Give people access**

   Users, then Access Control. Grant each role only the screens that role needs. See Users and access.

> **DO NOT SKIP STEP ONE**
>
> Everything to do with invoicing is blocked until each company has its TRN. The system will tell you, but it is a frustrating way to find out on a Thursday afternoon.

FINANCE

Money, in plain words

You do not need to understand double-entry bookkeeping to use this system, but four words appear everywhere and are worth two minutes.

Voucher

One transaction, written down. Every entry in the accounts is a voucher, and each gets a number that is never reused — `WBE/SI/26-26/0003` means WB Engineering, sales invoice, financial year 26–26, the third one.

Debit and credit

Two sides of the same transaction. Every voucher has to have both, and they have to be equal. The system checks this and will not let an unbalanced voucher through, so you cannot create a mess by accident.

Account

A named pot that money moves in and out of — Cash at Bank, Accounts Receivable, Salaries & Wages. The full list is your *chart of accounts*.

Posting

Committing a transaction to the books. Before it is posted, nothing has happened. After it is posted, it is part of the record and can be reversed but not quietly edited.

Invoicing customers

A tax invoice is a legal document, not a letter. UAE law says what has to be on the face of it, and the system will not let you issue one that is missing anything. That is why there are two stages.

> ### Stage one: the draft
> `Finance → Entry → Invoices → New invoice`
>
> Choose the customer — the payment terms come from their record, so the due date fills itself in. Add a line for each thing you are billing, with a description, a quantity, a unit (metres, hours, lump sum), a rate and a VAT treatment. The totals at the bottom update as you type, broken down by VAT rate.
>
> **A draft posts nothing.** It is not in the books, it is not on the VAT return, and the customer has not been asked to pay. Save it, check it, come back to it tomorrow.

> ### Stage two: issuing it
> `The Issue button at the top of the draft`

> Issuing does three things at once: it posts the transaction to the accounts, it takes the next number in a series that must have no gaps, and it produces a document the customer can reclaim VAT against.
>
> Because of that, an issued invoice **cannot be edited**. If it is wrong, raise a credit note against it — that leaves both halves on the record, which is what an auditor expects to see.

Printing it for the customer

Once issued, a *Print* button appears. It produces the tax invoice as the customer receives it: your letterhead, both TRNs, every line with its quantity and rate, and the VAT shown *rate by rate* rather than as one lump — which is what the law requires.

> **WHY A REPRINT NEVER CHANGES**
>
> The customer's name, address and TRN are frozen onto the document at the moment you issue it. If they move offices next year, last year's invoice still reads as it was sent.

Credit and debit notes

Choose the document type at the top of a new invoice. A note must name the invoice it adjusts — a note that does not say what it corrects cannot be attributed to anything, and cannot be issued.

Supplier bills

On the Invoices screen, switch to *Suppliers billed us*. It works the same way with one difference: you enter **their** invoice number, not one of ours. That is the number an auditor will look for when matching your VAT reclaim to the paperwork.

Reverse charge — buying from abroad

When you buy services from outside the UAE, the supplier charges no VAT and you account for it yourself. Choose *Reverse charge* as the treatment on those lines. The system then puts the tax on both sides of your books, so it nets to nothing while still being declared in both halves of the VAT return — which is exactly what the FTA requires.

Day book and ledgers

> **Day Book**
>
> `Finance → Entry → Day Book`
>
> Every voucher in date order — the equivalent of Tally's day book. Filter by voucher type, search by reference, party, narration or an amount. This is where you go when somebody asks "what did we post on the 14th?".
>
> You can also raise a new journal entry from here, which is usually where you notice one is missing.

> **Ledgers**
>
> `Finance → Entry → Ledgers`
>
> Every movement on one account, with a running balance — or one customer's statement, which you can print and send.

> **FOLLOWING A FIGURE BACK**
>
> Any total on a report can be traced: click through from the report to the account, from the account to the voucher, and from the voucher to the invoice behind it. Nothing in this system is a number you cannot explain.

Cheques, retention and the bank

Cheque Register (post-dated cheques)

`Finance → Registers → Cheques`

A large share of UAE business is settled with cheques dated months ahead. The register tracks each one: the number, the bank, the date it can be banked, who holds the paper, and whether it has cleared or bounced. A post-dated cheque you are holding is not cash yet, and the system treats it that way.

Retention

`Finance → Registers → Retention`

The money a client holds back on each certificate — typically 5 or 10 per cent, half released at handover and half after the defects liability period. The register records what is held, on which job, and the date it becomes releasable, so nothing is quietly forgotten a year later.

It works in both directions: retention a client holds from you, and retention you hold from a subcontractor.

Bank Reconciliation

`Finance → Registers → Bank Rec`

Tick off each line against the bank statement each month. It is how you prove the cash figure in the accounts is real, rather than assuming it.

Advances

A mobilisation advance is normal on a UAE contract. Ten or fifteen per cent of the value arrives before anybody is on site, and comes back off the certificates a slice at a time over the year that follows. The same happens in the other direction, because a supplier will not order switchgear against a promise.

AN ADVANCE IS NOT INCOME

Nothing has been supplied when the money moves. Money a customer paid you is owed back until the work is billed. Money you paid a supplier is owed to you until they bill for it. Recording either as income makes one month look wonderful and every month after it look poor.

Advances

`Finance → Registers → Advances`

Record it when the money moves. Say which way it goes, choose the customer or supplier, and pick the bank account it went through. Either type the amount, or give the contract value and the percentage and let the screen work it out.

Unlike the retention register, this one posts. The money really has moved and nothing else is going to record it, so saving an advance puts it straight into your accounts.

Recovering it

Each time an invoice comes round, click *Recover* and enter the slice that comes off. What is left updates on its own, and the advance closes itself the moment nothing remains. The screen refuses an amount larger than the balance, because recovering more than was advanced would turn what you owe into an apparent asset.

Recovering an advance **moves no money**. It reduces what the customer owes, because they have already paid that much. The bank is untouched, because the cash arrived months ago.

VAT ON AN ADVANCE

Taking money for taxable work creates a tax point under UAE rules, so a tax invoice is due on it. Raise that on the Invoices screen and then recover the advance against it. No VAT is charged on this screen, which is what stops the same tax being declared twice.

The two other endings

- **Refund** when the money is genuinely going back. This moves real cash.
- **Write off** when it is not coming back. This takes the balance to the profit and loss, which is a decision rather than a correction.

Job costing

> **Job Costing**
> `Finance → Job Costing`
> What each job earned, what it cost, the margin, and how much of its budget is used. Jobs can be nested — a main contract with packages and variations beneath it — and the parent shows a true total without anything being posted against it directly.

Getting labour onto a job

Hours recorded on Attendance against a job are priced at each person's cost rate and charged to that job. Until that happens the margin is missing them, and the screen says so in as many words. The *Post labour* button does it.

> **TIME BOOKED TO NO JOB DISAPPEARS**
> Hours recorded without a job are not counted against any job's cost. The Manhours report shows them separately so you can see how much is drifting.

Work in progress

Job Costing tells you what a job earned and cost in a period. This answers a different question, and a cumulative one. How far through is each contract, and has the invoicing kept pace with the work?

> ### Work in Progress
> Finance → Job Costing → Work in Progress
>
> How far through a contract is, is measured by cost. What has been spent, against what the job was priced to cost. It uses figures already in your ledger and does not depend on anybody's opinion of how far along the site looks.
>
> Once you know a contract is sixty per cent complete, you know it has earned sixty per cent of its value. Comparing that with what you have actually invoiced is the whole point of the screen.

Billed ahead, and billed behind

On a long contract these two figures are almost never equal, and both are invisible in a profit and loss that simply totals what was invoiced.

WHAT IT SAYS	WHAT IT MEANS
Billed ahead of the work	You have invoiced more than you have earned. That surplus is not profit. It is money held against work you still owe.
Done, not yet billed	You have earned more than you have invoiced. Work is finished and nobody has asked the client to pay for it.
In line	Invoicing has kept pace with the work.
Budget not set	Nothing about this contract can be measured until a budget cost is on the job.

The two are shown separately and never netted off. One contract a million ahead and another a million behind is not the same business as two sitting exactly on plan.

> **A CONTRACT HEADING FOR A LOSS**

> When a job is expected to cost more than it will ever be paid, the whole loss belongs in this period rather than spread over the months remaining. Those contracts are listed first, under an amber banner. A loss you see in month three is still a decision you can act on. One that surfaces in month eleven is only an explanation.

> **WHY THERE IS NO DATE FILTER**
>
> A contract question is cumulative from the day the job started. Filtering to a financial year would report a two-year contract as barely begun every January.

VAT and corporate tax

> ### VAT Return (VAT 201)
>
> `Finance → Tax → VAT`
>
> The return laid out box by box exactly as the FTA form asks for it: standard-rated supplies, zero-rated, exempt, reverse charge, and the tax on each. It is built from the treatment you set on every line, which is why a single invoice can be split across three boxes.
>
> Before filing, the screen agrees the return to the two VAT control accounts in your books. If they disagree, something was posted to the wrong account and it says so.

Choosing the VAT treatment

TREATMENT	USE IT WHEN
Standard	Normal 5% work billed inside the UAE. Most of what you do.

Zero-rated	0% but still a taxable supply — exports outside the GCC, international transport.
Exempt	No VAT and not recoverable — certain financial services, bare land, local passenger transport.
Out of scope	Outside UAE VAT altogether — supplies made and consumed abroad.
Reverse charge	You account for the tax yourself on an import. It goes on both sides and nets to nil.

> ### Corporate Tax
> `Finance → Tax → Corporate Tax`
>
> Nine per cent on taxable profit above AED 375,000, with the return and the payment both due nine months after the period ends. The screen works out the deadline, tracks whether you qualify for Small Business Relief, and carries losses forward within the 75% relief cap.
>
> It also shows why taxable profit is not the same as the profit in your accounts, line by line, so the adjustment is explainable rather than magic.

Closing a period

Once a VAT return is filed, set the *books locked to* date on the company. Nothing can then be posted on or before that date, so the figures behind a return you have already sent cannot move.

Electronic invoicing

UAE eInvoicing does not work by sending anything to the FTA yourself. It runs through an **Accredited Service Provider**: this system hands them the document, and they validate it, sign it and transmit it. There are five parties involved — you, your provider, your customer's provider, your customer, and the FTA.

Electronic Invoicing

`Finance → Tax → e-Invoicing`

Every issued invoice with where it has got to. *Sent*, *Accepted* and *Delivered* are separate states rather than one tick, because a document can be accepted by your provider and refused by your customer's hours later — and somebody has to be able to see which happened.

Preview before you send. It shows the exact document that would leave, and lists anything a validator would refuse. A rejection from somebody else's system arrives long after your customer already has the invoice.

> **SWITCHING IT ON**
>
> Nothing is transmitted until you name your provider on Finance → Setup, along with the two identifiers they give you. Until then your invoicing is entirely unaffected.

PEOPLE

Employee records

Employees

`HR → People → Employees`

Everyone the group employs. Search by name, employee number, mobile, email, department, or any number from an Emirates ID, passport, visa or MOL Person ID.

The profile holds the personal details, the UAE documents with their expiry dates, the contract, the salary and bank details for WPS, and any custom fields your administrator has added.

Supplied labour

Mark a worker as *Supplied* and name the manpower supplier. They are then kept out of your payroll, out of the WPS file, and out of your workforce mix — because they are sponsored by the supplier and sit on the supplier's establishment, not yours.

> **THE SYSTEM REFUSES A DUPLICATE PERSON**
>
> If an Emirates ID or passport number is already on somebody else's record, it says whose. This is deliberate: the same man on two records means two salaries and a WPS file the bank rejects.

Onboarding

`HR → People → Onboarding`

Requisition to offer to joining, so a new hire arrives with their file already complete rather than being assembled afterwards.

Certifications

`HR → People → Certifications`

Trade tickets, medicals and third-party certificates with their renewal dates.

Attendance and leave

Attendance & Muster

`HR → Time → Attendance`

The daily muster: who was present, absent, on leave or off. Record the actual in and out times where you have them, because two rules need them — the night overtime rate, and the summer midday ban.

Log the hours against a job here as well. That is what puts labour into job costing.

If you have a punch machine, its file can be imported rather than typed.

Leave

> `HR → Time → Leave`
>
> Requests, approvals and balances. Annual leave builds up from the join date — two days a month between six months and a year, then the full entitlement — so the balance is earned rather than granted, and it is calculated rather than typed.

The summer midday break

Between 15 June and 15 September, outdoor work is banned between 12:30 and 15:00. The Compliance report reads your attendance records and lists any day where somebody appears to have worked through it. The punch data is the evidence either way.

Payroll and WPS

> **Payroll**
>
> `HR → Payroll`
>
> Run the month, review every payslip, then approve. The system works out basic and allowances, overtime at both rates, absence and unpaid-leave deductions, salary-advance recovery, and part months for anyone who joined or left partway through.
>
> Nothing is a guess: every figure traces back to attendance, to the employee's contract, or to your HR policy.

> **PAYROLL REACHES THE ACCOUNTS BY ITSELF**
>
> Approving a run posts the wage cost to the ledger. You do not raise a journal entry for salaries.

"Somebody is not ready"

Payroll will hold a person back rather than pay them wrongly — no salary set, no join date, missing bank details. It names each one and why. Fix the record and run again.

The WPS file for the bank

The SIF file the UAE Wage Protection System requires. The system validates the IBAN with its checksum, the MOL Person ID and the routing code before generating it, and tells you exactly which employee is holding it up — far better than the bank rejecting the whole file.

Overtime, the two rates

Ordinary overtime is 125% of basic. Night work between 22:00 and 04:00, rest days and public holidays are 150%. The hours come from attendance, not from a typed figure, and the Overtime report shows what it is costing and whether anybody has gone over the legal cap of two hours a day.

When someone leaves

> **Separation & Settlement**
>
> `HR → People → Separation`
>
> The full end-of-service calculation: gratuity at 21 days of basic per year for the first five years and 30 days after, capped at two years' pay; unused leave encashed; pending salary; notice pay; the repatriation ticket. Unpaid leave is excluded from the service period, as the law requires.
>
> It prints as a settlement statement the employee signs.

Your HR policy

> **HR Policy**
>
> `HR → HR Policy`

> Your handbook, expressed as the numbers every other screen reads. Leave days, when leave starts accruing, carry-forward, probation and notice periods, working hours, overtime rates and caps, sick pay bands, gratuity, and the air ticket.
>
> Set it once per company, and every calculation follows it — leave balances, payslips, overtime, the final settlement.

> **"THAT IS BELOW WHAT THE LAW ALLOWS"**
>
> The system refuses anything under the statutory minimum and tells you which article of Federal Decree-Law 33/2021 says so. You may always be *more* generous than the law; you may never be less.

REPORTS

Finding the right report

Open Finance or HR and click **All reports** at the right-hand end of the tabs. Every report you are allowed to open is there, grouped by subject, and each card says the *question it answers* rather than only its official name.

Search using the plain word you would say out loud. Typing `owes` finds Outstanding & Ageing; `expire` finds the visa and Emirates ID renewals; `bounced` finds returned cheques.

What each report answers

REPORT	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS
Cash Flow Forecast	Will there be enough in the bank to cover the next payroll?

Outstanding & Ageing	Who owes us money, who do we owe, and how overdue is it?
Cheque Register	Which post-dated cheques clear this month, and which have bounced?
Retention Register	How much of our money is held back, and when is it released?
Advances Register	How much have we taken up front, and how much is still to be earned?
Bank Reconciliation	Does our cash book agree with the bank statement?
Profit & Loss / Balance Sheet	Did we make money this period, and what do we own and owe?
Trial Balance	Do the books balance, account by account?
Cost Centres	What is each department or site costing us?
Job Costing	What did each job earn and cost, and is it inside its budget?
Work in Progress	How far through is each contract, and have we billed ahead of the work?
Manhours	How many hours has each job eaten, against how many it was priced for?
Overtime	What is overtime costing, and is anybody over the legal cap?
Workforce Mix	How mixed are the nationalities, and what would change the balance?
Compliance & Expiry	Whose visa, Emirates ID, labour card or passport is about to expire?

Payroll & Payslips	What was paid last month, to whom, and what went to the bank?
VAT Return	What do we owe the FTA this quarter, box by box?
Corporate Tax	What corporate tax is due, and by when?
Day Book	Everything posted, in date order.
Ledgers & Statements	Every movement on one account, or one customer's statement.

Two reports worth a closer look

Cash Flow Forecast

`Finance → Reports → Cash Flow`

Every other finance report looks backwards. This one looks forward: what is in the bank today, then thirteen weeks of everything already dated to move — cheques you hold and cheques you have written, invoices on their due dates, retention on its release date, and wages on payday.

The sentence at the top says in one line whether you are fine, getting tight, or heading for an overdraft — and in which week. Any week that closes below zero is shaded red.

Turn on **Cautious view** before promising anybody anything. It removes money you are owed but cannot be sure of, while keeping every payment you must make. If the answer is still yes, it is a real yes.

Workforce Mix

`HR → Reports → Workforce Mix`

The nationality mix of your own employees, measured against the share you are working to. Where you are over, it gives three ways to close the gap: hires needed, the equivalent reduction, and how many of those visas fall due within ninety days.

> Supplied labour is excluded — those workers sit on the supplier's establishment, not yours.

RUNNING THE SYSTEM

Approvals

Anything that needs a second pair of eyes goes through the approvals inbox. An administrator sets the routes: which kinds of request need approving, and by whom, based on the approval level of each role.

- **Raising one:** the request goes to whoever the route names, and they are notified.
- **Acting on one:** open Approvals, read it, approve or reject with a reason. The reason is kept.
- The bell in the top bar shows how many things are waiting on you.

Users and access

Access is granted **per screen**, and separately for viewing, creating, editing, deleting and approving. A site storekeeper might see only Inventory; an accountant sees Finance. If a screen is not granted, it is not in the menu at all — and typing its address simply returns you to your dashboard.

That is also why a button can be missing rather than present-and-refusing: being allowed to *see* a screen and being allowed to *change* it are two different grants.

The roles that ship with the system

ROLE	APPROVAL LEVEL
Group Admin	100

Managing Director	90
Director	80
Operations Manager	70
Finance Controller	60
Project Manager	50
Finance / Accounts · HSE Officer · Procurement Officer	45
Estimation / Sales Engineer · QA/QC & Calibration	40
Site Engineer / Planner	35
HR Officer	30
Storekeeper	20
Site Timekeeper	10

Managing users

- **Reset a password:** the key icon. A temporary password is shown once — hand it over, and the user must set their own on first sign-in.
- **Lock or unlock:** the lock icon. Accounts also lock themselves for fifteen minutes after three wrong passwords.
- **Master data:** the dropdown lists used across the system — departments, designations, grades, leave types, nationalities. Keeping these tidy keeps every dropdown clean.
- **Custom fields:** anything the standard employee profile does not capture. It then appears on every profile.

The audit trail

> **Audit Log**
>
> `Administration → Audit Log`
>
> A permanent record of who did what and when — created, updated, approved, deleted, posted — together with the address and device it came from. Sign-ins, sign-outs, failed attempts and lock-outs are recorded here too.
>
> Nothing here can be edited or deleted by anybody, including an administrator. Entries older than the period you set move to an *Archive* tab, which is never emptied, and both tabs show their counts so nothing ever looks lost.

Finding something in it

A year of entries cannot be scrolled, so the trail can be questioned directly. The search box looks at what was done and who did it. *More filters* adds one person, one kind of action, one kind of record, and a date range. They combine, so everything one person deleted in a single week is three clicks.

- The sentence above the list always says what you are looking at, so a filtered list is never mistaken for the whole trail.
- Dates include the whole of the last day. Asking up to the 14th includes everything done on the 14th.
- Switching between Recent and Archive keeps your filters rather than throwing them away.

> **SENDING SOMEBODY WHAT YOU FOUND**
>
> The address bar carries the filters. Copy the link and send it, and they open exactly the view you were looking at.

> **NAMES YOU DO NOT RECOGNISE**

> A failed sign-in against an unknown email address is ordinary background noise on any site facing the internet. A run of them against one of your real accounts is not.

REFERENCE

When something is refused

The system prefers to refuse clearly rather than accept something wrong quietly. Here is what the common refusals mean.

WHAT IT SAYS	WHAT TO DO
Your own VAT registration number is missing	Companies → edit the company → VAT registration number. A tax invoice is not valid without it.
This customer has no TRN on file	Finance → Registers → Parties. A standard-rated invoice to a registered business needs one — or confirm they are not registered.
The books are closed up to…	The period has been locked after a filing. Post on a later date, or ask an administrator to move the lock.
An issued invoice cannot be changed	Raise a credit note against it. Both halves stay on the record, which is what an auditor expects.
That document has already been posted	Somebody has already issued it — possibly you, in another tab. Refresh and check before trying again.
Somebody is not ready for payroll	The screen names each person and the missing detail. Fix the employee record and run again.

That Emirates ID is already on someone else	The same person exists twice. Find the older record and deactivate it rather than creating a second.
That is below what the law allows	An HR policy figure is under the statutory minimum. The message names the article.
That is more than is left on this advance	Recovering more than was advanced would turn what you owe into an apparent asset. The message names what remains.
No account is marked as cash or bank	Open Ledgers and set the control type on your bank and petty cash accounts. Advances and the cash flow forecast both need it.
Has records — deactivate instead	A company or record with transactions behind it is never deleted, because that would leave a hole. Deactivate it.

Glossary

Advance

Money that changes hands before any work is supplied. One received is owed back until the work is billed; one paid is owed to you until the supplier bills for it. Neither is income.

Ageing

Sorting what you are owed by how old it is — not yet due, 1–30 days, 31–60, 61–90, over 90.

Corporate Tax (CT)

UAE tax on business profit, 9% above AED 375,000. Separate from VAT, with its own registration number.

Cost centre

A part of your own business you want to measure — a department, a workshop, a site office. Different from a job, which is work you sell.

Credit note

A document that cancels or reduces an invoice already issued.

Defects liability period

The months after handover during which you must return and fix defects. The second half of retention is usually released at the end of it.

FTA

Federal Tax Authority — VAT and corporate tax.

Gratuity

End-of-service pay, earned after one completed year: 21 days of basic per year for the first five, 30 days a year after that.

ILOE

Involuntary Loss of Employment insurance. A small compulsory scheme; the fine for not subscribing is AED 400.

Job

A piece of work you sell — a contract, a project, a service call. Costs and revenue are tagged to it so you can see whether it made money.

MOHRE

Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation — labour law, work permits and establishment classification.

MOL Person ID

The unique number identifying a worker to the Ministry. It goes in the WPS file. Formerly called the labour card number.

Muster

The daily attendance record on site.

Nafis / Emiratisation

The requirement to employ a share of UAE nationals, and the programme supporting it.

Onerous contract

One expected to cost more than it will ever be paid. The whole expected loss is taken now rather than spread over the months remaining.

PDC

Post-dated cheque — a cheque that cannot be banked until the date written on it.

Reverse charge

When you buy from abroad and account for the VAT yourself instead of the supplier charging it.

Retention

Money a client holds back from each payment as security, released in stages.

Small Business Relief

Relief from corporate tax for businesses under AED 3,000,000 of revenue, available for periods ending on or before 31 December 2029.

TRN

Tax Registration Number — the 15-digit number the FTA issues on VAT registration. It must appear on every tax invoice.

VAT 201

The FTA's VAT return form.

Voucher

One transaction recorded in the accounts, with its own permanent number.

WPS

Wage Protection System. Salaries must be paid through it, using a SIF file sent to your bank.

Work in progress (WIP)

The gap between what a contract has earned and what has been invoiced for it. Billed ahead of the work is a liability; work done and not billed is an asset.

Zero-rated vs exempt

Both charge no VAT, but zero-rated is still a taxable supply and lets you reclaim your input tax. Exempt does not.